

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 238

By Massey

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Edward Bruce Foster, Jr., of Knoxville.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Edward Bruce Foster, Jr.; and

WHEREAS, a highly regarded business attorney and community leader, Bruce Foster was known for his self-effacing nature and skill at building consensus; and

WHEREAS, born on May 1, 1936, in Knoxville, Mr. Foster was encouraged by his father, who was also a successful Knoxville attorney, to finish his education quickly; taking up the challenge, he earned a Bachelor of Science degree in Business Administration in 1957 and a law degree from the University of Tennessee, Knoxville, in 1958 at the age of twenty-two; and

WHEREAS, following law school, Mr. Foster received a commission as a first lieutenant in the U.S. Army Judge Advocate General's Corps, serving on active duty in France from 1959 to 1963, during the time that the Berlin Wall was being built; and

WHEREAS, while in Europe, he rarely missed the opportunity to ski the Alps or tour the backroads of France; after his discharge at the rank of captain, Bruce Foster returned to Knoxville as an associate at the law firm of Frantz, McConnell & Seymour and soon rose to partner as a trial attorney serving the legal needs of corporate clients; and

WHEREAS, in 1991, Mr. Foster joined the firm of Bass, Berry, and Sims, which was opening its first Knoxville office; and

WHEREAS, among his many achievements, Bruce Foster was a lifelong member of the Tennessee Bar Association, served as president of the Knoxville Bar Association, was a member of the Tennessee State Constitutional Convention of 1977, and served as a Special

Justice on the Tennessee Supreme Court during Governor Lamar Alexander's administration;  
and

WHEREAS, Mr. Foster had been listed in *The Best Lawyers in America* since 1987 and served on numerous boards, including the Greater Knoxville Chamber of Commerce, the Public Building Authority, and the Central YMCA and United Way of Greater Knoxville, where he also served as general counsel; he was also a member of the commission that formed the Knoxville Central Business Improvement District in 1993, with the aim to create a vibrant, flourishing downtown; and

WHEREAS, as a young man, Bruce Foster relished the competitive atmosphere of the courtroom, but late in his career, he re-trained in mediation, at which he also excelled; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Foster retired in 2016 at the age of eighty, bidding farewell to his last remaining client, the Metropolitan Knoxville Airport Authority, which he had estimably served for thirty years; and

WHEREAS, personal relationships and his faith meant a great deal to him, as did a sense of duty and responsibility toward his family and community; Bruce Foster was known to be generous with his time and encouraging to others, whether other lawyers in his firm or those he worked with at his church or in the community; and

WHEREAS, for more than thirty years, Mr. Foster hosted a covenant group from Second Presbyterian Church at his home for breakfast, study, and prayer; a lifelong member of "2<sup>nd</sup> Pres," Bruce Foster was elected deacon and ruling elder, delivered groceries for the FISH Pantry, and trained and served as a Stephen Minister; and

WHEREAS, left to cherish his memory are his loving wife of fifty-five years, Betsy; children, Bailey Foster (Marcia Tobin) and Benjamin Foster (Emiko Kunita); sister and brother-in-law, Lee and Bill Monroe; niece, Meg Stone; and four grandchildren, Henry, Maggie, Kaya, and Sho; and

WHEREAS, he was preceded in death by his mother and father, Mary Evelyn and Edward Bruce Foster; sister and brother-in-law, Lyn and Gary Scales; niece, Mary Katherine Stone; and many friends; and

WHEREAS, Bruce Foster leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Edward Bruce Foster, Jr., reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character, his extraordinary contributions to the people of Tennessee, and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Foster.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.